

Sports Management 2

Introduction

This course applies business concepts that you have learned during the MBA program to the industry of sports. This industry is very diverse ranging from sports as leisure to professional sports, from events such as a World Cup or the Olympic Games to the leagues at the local level, from individual sports to team sports, from profit-making products to agents of social change. Each sport has its particular features and the various actors—such as players, coaches, fans, team managers, league managers, media, equipment providers, sponsors, and governments—play different roles. Each sport can be analyzed at different levels from leagues and tournaments at the top going through teams, events, and individual players. At each level and across levels, the actors of sport interact to create value and allocate the value created.

Course Objectives & Outcomes

“SPORTS” has three objectives. First and foremost, the course aims to give participants insights into the sports industry, especially from a managers’ perspective. Secondly, the course will provide participants with a platform to integrate knowledge from other parts of the MBA program. Third, “SPORTS” will give industry insights that can be applied in other industries.

Evaluation

The course grade will be determined as of IESE policies. It will be calculated as follows:

Description	Percentage
Individual reports (SE1)	60%
Performance in class (SE2)	40%

Assistance is mandatory. This course is dynamic with strong participation from the participants. Therefore 40% of the grade will be based on class participation. The remaining 60% will be dependent on 2 assignments. Maximum 750 words/assignment. You can choose from any of these combos (no mixing). DETERMINE WHAT THE SINGLE MOST IMPORTANT ISSUE OF THE CASE IS AND PROVIDE SOLUTIONS

- Combo #1: Brita's Stephen Curry Sponsorship Splash, The National Football League and Brain Injuries
- Combo #2: IJCSM Internationalizing a Sports Agency (A), The Indian Premier League 2020
- Combo #3: Negotiating for Equal Pay, The Globalization of Manchester City

Assignments must be put on Blackboard before the start of the relevant session and this assignment is individual as well as authentic. I.e. I expect your observations (not of someone else, nor any generative pre-trained platform such as Chat GPT).

I expect you to explain the core issues as well as how you would have tackled them.

Course Outline

Session 1	The Structure of Sports
Sport	College Sports
Region	Canada and USA
Case	Ivey - W14102 - The monopolistic power of the NCAA
Questions	1. Explain the disparity among the 'haves' and 'have-nots' in college athletics. 2. Explain how NCAA bylaws on amateurism and its core values based on education are linked. 3. Explain the ramifications for the NCAA if the wealthiest and most pedigreed college athletic programs split away from the NCAA and formed their own league and rules of governance. 4. How should Marc Emmert position the NCAA in order to provide a sustainable business model to its member institutions?
Session 2	Sport Leagues, Value Creation and Business Model
Sport	Ice Hockey
Region	Canada and USA
Case	IJCSM, The National Hockey League (NHL), Volume 18, issue 2, 06/20
Questions	1. Is the NHL a professional sports league that stands out today? 2. What is the NHL's biggest strength? What are its weaknesses? 3. Craft an initial plan for future sustainable growth. What are its main elements?
Session 3	The Sports Industry
Sport	Golf
Region	World
Case	IJCSM Internationalizing a Sports Agency (A), Volume 18, issue 1, 03/20
Questions	1. Assess Pro-G's entry into the US Market. 2. Would you let Schmidt continue with business as usual,

replace him, or try to manage him? Formulate an action plan to deal with the situation.

3. Any observations concerning Pro-G's strategy in general?

Session 4

Sports, Innovation, and Digitalization

Sport	Tennis
Region	World
Case	IN2016, Infosys: Digital Innovation and Tennis (A)
Questions	1. Should Infosys consider expanding into partnerships in other sports? If so, which ones and how? 2. How could Infosys impact other organizations within the tennis ecosystem? 3. What other innovations could it explore with its current partners? Explain. 4. How can Infosys establish itself as the preferred technology provider for clients' digital transformation strategies through tennis partnerships?

Session 5

Sports and Entrepreneurship

Sport	Cricket
Region	India
Case	HBS 9-721-362 The Indian Premier League, 2020
Questions	1. Why do people watch sports? What do they want to see in a game? 2. What made the IPL so successful? Why? 3. Why are the team owners willing to be regulated? What did they learn from NFL? 4. What did they do? What did they not do 5. Do you see any further opportunities

Session 6

Sponsorship decisions

Sport	Basketball
Region	USA
Case	NAO594 - Brita's Stephen Curry Sponsorship Splash
Questions	1. Who did Brita compete against for its chosen customers? 2. How did Brita position its brand relative to these alternatives? 3. To what extent was Curry a good fit for the Brita brand? 4. Based on your analysis, how should Kittredge use the Curry sponsorship to turn around the brand's market performance?

Session 7

Motivation and Incentives

Sport	Soccer
Region	USA
Case	HBS 9-920-029 Negotiating for Equal Pay: The US Women's

	National Soccer Team (A)
Questions	1. Was the compensation received by the US Women's National Soccer Team fair relative to the compensation received by the US Men's National Soccer Team? In general, what makes a compensation package fair? 2. Think about a time when your compensation was unfair. How did you react? If you have never had that experience, imagine how you would in such a situation

Session 8 Leadership and Sports

Sport	Rowing
Region	South Africa
Case	Ivey W19785 Rowing South Africa: Leadership Lessons through Sport
Questions	1. What examples in the case show evidence of the practice of self-efficacy? 2. Analyze the case against the different building blocks of a learning organization. 3. Assess the various lessons that the case offers organizations for developing individuals and teams. 4. Evaluate the particular challenges facing athletes and rowing in South Africa. Given these challenges, how should Mabaso respond?

Session 9 Ethical Considerations in Sport

Sport	NFL
Region	USA
Case	HBS 9-815-071 The National Football League and Brain Injuries
Questions	1. Do you think that the NFL and franchise owners are meeting their obligations to employee healthy and safety? If not, should they? Explain. 2. Do you think that the NFL's and owners' responsibilities have changed now that potential long-term health risks are more widely understood? 3. Do you think that the changes made in terms of rules, equipment, and player health assessment to date have been sufficient? 4. If you were the owner of an NFL franchise team, would you look to sell your team, or do you think the NFL will continue as a viable and profitable business? Note: Make sure to read the case Appendix

Session 10 Team Globalization

Sport	Soccer
Region	Europe
Case	HBS 9-723-391 The Globalization of Manchester City Football Group

Questions

1. What are the potential benefits and risks of going global by acquiring clubs in the soccer business?
 2. Do you think the benefits outweigh the risks? If so, why haven't other soccer clubs expanded globally through acquisitions?
 3. Should Ferran buy Bahia?
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Bibliography

All cases are provided and reading them and preparing for the sessions is mandatory. For participants who want to dig deeper into the subject I recommend: Sports Business Management, G. Foster, N. O'Reilly, A. Davila, Routledge, 2nd Ed., 2021, ISBN: 978-0-367-35606-4.

Professor's Biography

Jan Simon



Full-time Professor of the Practice of Management of Entrepreneurship and Financial Management

Prof. e-mail: jSimon@iese.edu

Office: B-421

Assistant: Denise Clerc

Assistant e-mail: dclerc@iese.edu

Jan Simon is Professor of the Practice of Management in Entrepreneurship at IESE and the Academic Director of its International Search Fund Center.

Jan worked over two decades in the investment industry. He co-headed the Emerging Markets Trading Desk at Salomon Brothers, set up the Continental Sales-Trading Desk at Goldman Sachs, and was a member of Merrill Lynch's Hedge Fund Advisory Group. He has been a Special Advisor to Pacific Lake Partners and is the Managing Partner of Vonzeo Capital, a global institutional investor in search funds.

His expertise is in the areas of investment strategies, mergers and acquisitions and, entrepreneurial acquisitions. He has managed money in equities, fixed income, search funds, and advised hedge funds in a variety of strategies. His research has been published in academic journals such as the Journal of Network Theory in Finance and the British Journal of Management.

Jan holds an LL.B. and LL.M. from the Katholieke Universiteit Leuven, an MBA from IESE Business School, earned his Ph.D. in Finance from the University of Essex, holds the ICD.D Designation for corporate directors from the Rotman School of Management, and earned his AMP at Harvard Business School.

He served the 1st Battalion of Parachutists and Commandos -Special Operations Regiment-,

as well as NATO's Special Intervention Forces -ACE Mobile Force. He holds both the green and red beret.

Learning Outcomes

These are the Learning Outcomes:

- Understand the international economic and social environment to assess opportunities and risks for business development in other countries. (OP01)
- Know the key elements of business sustainability and learn how to implement it within companies. (OP02)
- Interact as a company executive with primary internal and external stakeholders. (OP03)
- Apply technological innovation and new digital infrastructures to business models. (OP08)
- Build and manage interactive data systems, model and analyze information for decision-making purposes. (OP09)
- Assess new businesses in their early stages for initial rounds of financing. (OP10)
- Conceptualize, design, analyze, and apply new business models. (OP12)
- Critically evaluate relevant information for improved decision-making. (R01)
- Integrate economic efficiency, ethical criteria of respect for human dignity, and planetary sustainability in decision-making. (R10)
- Lead diverse teams by optimizing resources and inspiring trust, which translates into commitment and autonomy for the rest of the team. (R11)
- Analyze the impact of business decisions from a general management perspective, operating within a global competitive context. (R22)
- Apply an entrepreneurial mindset, with a creative and open attitude, driving necessary changes with energy and personal responsibility. (R23)

Formative Activities

Time distribution for each formative activity:

Description	Hours
Sessions with the professor (AF1)	19h
Individual student work (AF2)	20h
Teamwork (AF3)	8h
Assessments & Exams (AF4)	3h

Sustainable Development Goals

While not primarily focused on sustainability, this course meaningfully incorporates sustainability-related content and perspectives where relevant. Topics such as environmental impact, social responsibility, or ethical considerations are introduced in connection with the core subject, through readings, activities, or discussions. This integration enhances students' understanding of sustainability within the broader context of business and society.

It addresses the following SDGs:

- SDG3. Good Health and well-being
- SDG5. Gender equality
- SDG8. Decent work and economic growth
- SDG10. Reduced inequalities
- SDG17. Partnerships for the goals